

Musical term	Meaning
légèrement, leggiero	light, nimble
leichtlent, lento	slow (lento: slowly)
liberamente, librement	freely
l'istesso	the same (l'istesso tempo: at the same speed)
loco	at the normal pitch
lunga	long
maestoso	majestic
main	hand (main gauche, m.g.: left hand; main droite, m.d.: right hand)
mano	hand (mano sinistra, m.s.: left hand; mano destra, m.d.: right hand)
marcato, marc	accented
martelé, martellato	strongly accented
mesto	sad
mezza, mezzo	half, moderately (mezzo forte, mf: moderately loud; mezza voce: in an undertone)
misterioso	mysteriously
misura	measure (alla misura: in strict time; senza misura: in free time)
moderato, modéré	at a moderate speed
morendo	fading away
mosso	with motion, animated
moto, movimento	movement, motion
mouvement, mouvt	movement, motion (au mouvement: in time; premier mouvement: original tempo)
naturale, nat.	naturally, in the usual way
nobilmente	nobly
nuovo	new (di nuovo: again)
obbligato	obligatory—indicating an instrument's important role
ossia	or, alternatively—shows an alternative, simpler version of a passage
ostinato	persistant (basso ostinato: a bass line with a repeated rhythm or melodic figure)
ottava, ott.	octave (ottava bassa: octave lower; ottava alta: octave higher)
parlando	like speech, pronounced clearly
pausa	rest
pesante	heavy, ponderous
piacevole	pleasant
piano, p	played or sung softly (pianissimo, pp: very quiet)

Musical term	Meaning
pizzicato, pizz	pinched, plucked
ponticello	on the bridge, in string playing, an indication to bow or to pluck very near to the bridge
portamento	carrying, slide
presto	very quickly, fast
ralentir	slowing
rallentando, rall.	broadening of the tempo, progressively slower
retenu	hold back
rigoroso	strict
ritardando, ritard, rit.	slowing down, decelerating
ritenuto, riten., rit.	suddenly slower, held back
ritmico	rhythmical
rubato, tempo rubato	robbed, flexible in tempo
scherzando, scherzoso	playful, humorous
schnell	fast
sec, secco	dry—staccato, without resonance
segue	carry on to the next section without a pause
sforzando, sforzato, sfz, sf	made loud, a sudden strong accent
sordino, sord.	mute
sostenuto, sost.	sustained, lengthened
sotto voce	in an undertone, quietly
sourdine	mute
spiccato	distinct, separated
spiritoso	spiritedly
staccato, stacc.	making each note brief and detached
stretto	tight, narrow
stringendo	gradually getting faster
tacet	silent, do not play
tenuto, ten.	held
tranquillo	calmly, peacefully
tremolando, tremolo, trem.	shaking
tutti	all, all together
unisono, unis.	in unison
veloce	to be played rapidly
vibrato	vibrating
vigorouso	vigorously
vite	fast
vivace, vivement, vivo	lively, brisk